Industrial Safety Processes

Elevating Devices

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Types of elevators

- Traction/Electric
  - Wire rope systems
  - High-rise systems
- Hydraulic
  - Hydraulic machinery
  - Used for short applications (6 floors or less)

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Inspection and Maintenance

- Detailed maintenance requirements are specified in the main elevator code – CSA B-44
  - Check provincial regulations for which version is in place – not always the most recent – and modifications often made
- Different levels of maintenance must be performed on a monthly, quarterly and annual basis
- Certifications from provincial regulator required

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Inspection and Maintenance

- Maintenance technicians must be knowledgeable on the equipment
- Records must be maintained at the site where the elevator/escalator is located
  - Can be electronic, but must be accessible on demand (not in personal emails, in locked-out computer)

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Emergency Issues

- Only qualified elevator technicians are permitted to “release” people trapped in elevators
- Post 9/11 to CSA B-44 requirements permit elevators to operate in fire alarm conditions
  - Thought to increase evacuation success
  - Major change to previous instructions – don’t use elevator in fire situations

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Escalator Issues

- Falls due to misjudging stair movement
  - Seniors most notably
- Hands, fingers, shoes caught in the teeth and combs
  - Major issue identified with soft “ballet slipper” shoes
  - People trying to retrieve dropped items or free caught items
- Falls from escalators over railings

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Man Lifts (Turbo Lifts)

- Various types may still exist in older industrial facilities
  - Essentially a form of “human conveyor”
- Not common
  - Hazardous, new regulations make fiscally impractical
  - Covered under CSA-B311
- “Man Lift” is more commonly used to describe boom lifts, extended boom lifts, or “Genie” lifts

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